Bevacizumab 5 mg/kg every 14 days

NCCP 00813 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking the treatment

Bevacizumab is given into a vein. The usual first infusion lasts 90 minutes; later infusions may take 60 and then 30 minutes if tolerated. Checks and observation add time. Report flushing, rash, breathing difficulty, dizziness or other new symptoms immediately.

STEP 2

A delayed infusion

If an appointment is missed or treatment is held, contact the unit for the revised plan. Do not assume the next calendar date is authorised.

STEP 3

Medicine and supplement review

Bring all prescription, over-the-counter and herbal medicines, vitamins and supplements to review. Include steroids, seizure medicines, anticoagulants and any recent antibiotics or antifungals. Tell the team before starting or stopping a medicine.

STEP 4

Surgery, procedures and wounds

Tell all treating teams that you receive bevacizumab. Major surgery needs an appropriate treatment interval and a fully healed wound before restarting; minor and dental procedures also need individual advice. Do not decide timing yourself or rely on the wallet stamp.

STEP 5

Pregnancy, breastfeeding and fertility

Discuss fertility preservation and contraception before starting. Treatment can harm a pregnancy. Do not breastfeed during treatment. Ask for the written medicine-specific precautions and the required periods after stopping; these may differ between products.

STEP 6

Appointments and transport

Before starting: Blood count, kidney/liver tests, urine protein, blood pressure and cardiac history/examination. During treatment: Regular blood count, kidney/liver tests and urine protein; blood pressure before each cycle and after treatment. MRI and neurological review follow your individual treatment plan. Echocardiography is considered only when indicated, including previous anthracycline treatment or chest-wall radiotherapy. If taking warfarin, INR is checked weekly until stable and before subsequent cycles.

STEP 7

Help with the daily plan

Agree who can help with transport, prescriptions, phone calls and recording symptoms if memory, vision, weakness or fatigue makes them difficult. Your consent and preferences guide what is shared. Keep the printed schedule and actual urgent contacts together.

STEP 8

Off-label treatment and infusion decisions

Bevacizumab for glioblastoma is outside its licensed indication in Ireland. The team should explain the reason for using it, expected benefit, uncertainty and alternatives as part of consent. Any rapid infusion outside the standard schedule has a separate local consent and governance process.

Sources: NCCP 00813 v2 · current Irish regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.